

Global role for India by 2045 (if all goes well)

- India could be one of the top 5 nations contributing to a safe and inclusive AGI
- Home to multiple AGI labs, startups, and open source models
- Contributor to global AGI governance framework (like the AI equivalent of the UN)
- Driving AGI for global good in climate, health, poverty, and education

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no harm in thinking about the next step: artificial super intelligence (ASI). But why go for ASI; what can we expect from it?

Obviously, artificial super intelligence would be way ahead of general intelligence. According to Microsoft's Copilot, "Artificial Super Intelligence (ASI) is a hypothetical form of AI that surpasses human intelligence in all aspects, including creativity, problem-solving, and emotional understanding. Unlike current AI systems, which are limited to specific tasks (artificial narrow intelligence or ANI), ASI would possess general intelligence and the ability to learn and adapt across various domains."

So, ASI is expected to surpass human intelligence in all aspects, including emotional understanding. Wow! Your close relation may not understand your emotions and feelings, but ASI would.

Some of the benefits of ASI that we can think of at present include making the best decisions for healthcare, finance, and research, developing life-saving drugs and improving treatments; space exploration and the creation of new materials and energy sources; and risk management and reducing the possibility of errors in our work. By the time ASI seems near, we will have thought of many more applications. Some experts suggest ASI could emerge within the next decade, while others believe it may take longer.

Where there are benefits, there are also some risks. For instance, ASI-controlled things might get out

of hand and lead to unforeseen results. It could lead to widespread unemployment and economic turmoil; some of its actions may not align with human values. So, tight control over ASI would be necessary. Fortunately, we still have time to tame and regulate it so that it acts in accordance with our wishes and does not become our master.

According to Sam Altman, CEO of OpenAI, this future may be closer than we think. He predicts, ASI could emerge within the next nine years, though the timeline remains speculative and dependent on breakthroughs in AI scaling and reasoning. While the idea may seem exciting to some, it also raises concerns about how such a powerful tool will reshape our lives, societies, and even our sense of purpose.

India needs to prepare a realistic roadmap for how it can emerge as a key contributor to artificial general intelligence over the next few years, and then work towards achieving artificial super intelligence. It will require strong policy support, funding, and coordination among academia, industry, and the government.

Is our education system preparing the young for the coming revolution? How will students, after graduating, survive in an autonomous world where most work will be done automatically? What are the skills and jobs that will still be relevant in the ASI-assisted world? What will be the new challenges before us? It is time to start thinking and preparing for it. **EFY**

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-Jeff Bezos

